



Riley.

BRAND GUIDELINES · V2.1 · THE DEFINITIVE EDITION · v2.1 FINAL LOGO SET · JULY 2026

The complete visual and verbal system for Riley — a companion for rebuilding your
life. Made by The 8:14 Project.

One light, one voice.

If you read nothing else: the entire brand is a single warm light in a dark room, and a friend who speaks plainly. Every decision below serves those two things.

THE MARK



A breathing gold sun and the word Riley with a gold period. Three marks in fixed rank: the Hero (primary), the Nav (secondary), the maker's-mark signature (tertiary). Nothing else is a logo.

THE PALETTE



Ink is the room. Parchment is the words. Gold is the light — one accent, used like it matters.

THE VOICE

“Start where you are. Riley will meet you there.”

Warm, honest, unhurried. Second person. No judgment, no hustle, no labels. A friend, not a clinician.

The idea

8:14 is a watch that stopped — read as a sunrise: **the minute the light comes back**. Riley is the product and the relationship; The 8:14 Project is the maker's mark and the soul. The category is **rebuilding** — not wellness, not recovery.

The test

Before shipping anything, ask: *Does it feel like a warm light in a dark room? Would a stranger know who they're about to meet? Would someone on their worst night feel safer having seen it?* Three yeses or it doesn't ship.

A sun that breathes.

The identity is one glowing gold orb — sunrise at 8:14. It gently breathes (a 5-second cycle) so the brand always feels alive and unhurried, like a presence rather than a graphic.



THE SUN · HIGHLIGHT SITS AT 40% / 35% — MORNING LIGHT, NOT NOON

THE RECIPE

```
background: radial-gradient(
  circle at 40% 35%,
  #E8D5A3, /* first light */
  #C9A84C 55%, /* gold */
  #A8842F /* deep edge */
);
box-shadow: 0 0 80px
  rgba(201,168,76,.40); /* the glow */
```

THE WORDMARK

Riley.

DM Serif Display, white, with a single **gold period**. The period is the signature — a calm full stop, a moment of arrival. It is always gold, and there is only ever one.

THE GLOW IS THE LOGO · THE FRAME IS THE VESSEL

The soft halo is part of the mark — never cropped, never removed, never sharpened into a hard circle. And the hero lockup includes its **hairline frame**: a 1px rule in Gold #C9A84C at **16% opacity**, corner radius = **4.35% of the side**. The frame is what makes the mark an object instead of a glow floating in the void. Its values are fixed — never improvised, never opaque, never any other color.

Two lockups. Room to glow.



PRIMARY · HERO — “I’M RILEY.” · FRAME INCLUDED

Marketing, splash, launch, social avatars. Sun above wordmark, inside the official hairline frame (§01). Minimum height 96px. Files: meet-riley-framed .png · .html · .mp4 · .gif (breathing, 5s loop). White alternate for light surfaces: §10.



SECONDARY · NAV — “RILEY.”

Nav bars, headers, sidebars, favicons. Sun left of word. Minimum ~18px sun / 120px wide. Files: riley-nav-logo.png · riley-nav-logo.html

THE HIERARCHY — FIXED RANK, NEVER REORDERED

- **1 · PRIMARY — Hero “I’m Riley.”** The face of the brand. Moments, marketing, launch, avatars — anywhere someone *meets* Riley. Framed, breathing when possible.
- **2 · SECONDARY — Nav “Riley.”** The working mark. Chrome: nav bars, headers, sidebars, favicons — anywhere Riley is already present and the mark just needs to hold the room.
- **3 · TERTIARY — Maker’s mark “Riley. by The 8:14 Project.”** The signature. Attribution voice: receipts, invoices, document footers, small print, co-branding. It closes a surface; it never leads one, and never replaces 1 or 2 where the sun can live.

One-line test: meeting Riley → Hero. Using Riley → Nav. Signing off → Maker’s mark.

- Clear space on every side $\geq$ the sun’s diameter — **measured outside the glow**, so the halo itself gets room.
- The mark sits on Ink or the deep end of a brand ground (§08). Never on photography busier than a ground, never on light (see §10).
- Hero for moments, Nav for chrome. If unsure which: how long will someone look at it? Moments get the Hero.

What not to do — shown.

The mark is finished. Scale it, don't rebuild it. Every example below actually happens to good logos; none may happen to this one.



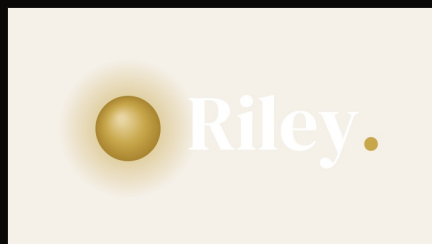
✓ Correct — glow intact, on Ink, room to breathe



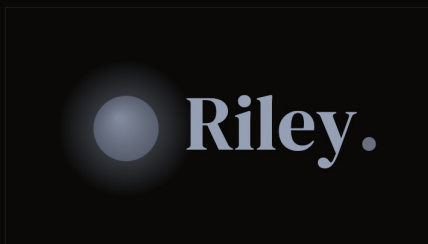
✗ Never stretch or squash



✗ No boxes or borders other than the official hairline frame (\$01) — never improvised, never opaque



✗ Never directly on light grounds (\$10 has the sanctioned treatment)



✗ Never recolor — the sun is gold or it is not the sun



✗ Never rotate or tilt

Also never: drop the glow, change the wordmark font, add a second period, improvise frame values (the hairline is fixed, \$01), animate anything except the breathe (\$06), or place the sun inside photography as if it were an object in the scene.

Ink, gold, and warmth.

Near-black ink lets the gold glow. Gold is the single accent — used sparingly, it means warmth, hope, and “you matter.” Parchment carries the words. Sage and blue support quietly; red is reserved for care.



Ink

#0A0908

Primary background — the room



Ink 2

#141210

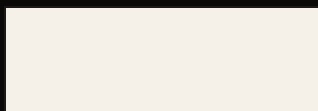
Cards, raised surfaces



Ink 3

#1C1A18

Borders, dividers, hover



Parchment

#F5F0E8

Primary text on dark



Gold

#C9A84C

THE accent — the period, CTAs, key moments



Gold Light

#E8D5A3

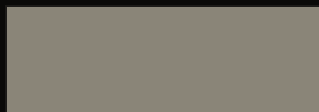
Sun highlight, hover states



Gold Deep

#A8842F

Sun edge, shadow, light-surface accent



Smoke

#8A8578

Secondary / muted text on dark



Sage Green

#4A7C59

Growth, progress, success



Blue

#4A7AB0

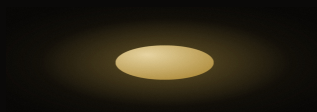
Calm, information



Signal Red

#E0685C

Care flags ONLY — never errors-as-anger, never sales urgency



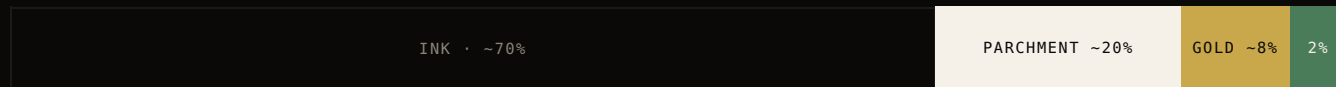
Sun Gradient

E8D5A3 → C9A84C → A8842F

The orb only — never UI fills

Mostly night, a little light.

The proportions are the brand. If a screen or post starts feeling gold-heavy, it stops feeling like Riley — the light matters because the room is dark.



THE 70 / 20 / 8 / 2 RULE — INK / PARCHMENT / GOLD / SEMANTIC COLOR

DO

- One gold moment per screen or post — the period, a CTA, a single highlighted word.
- Sage for progress and streaks; blue for informational calm; both at whisper volume.
- Text is Parchment on Ink; muted text is Smoke. That's it.

DON'T

- No gold paragraphs, gold backgrounds, or gold-on-gold.
- No red for errors, deadlines, or discounts — red belongs to care flags alone.
- No new colors, tints, or “just this once” gradients. The palette is closed.

SEMANTIC MEANINGS — COLOR AS LANGUAGE

Gold = warmth, arrival, “this matters.” · **Sage** = growth, a day counted, something kept. · **Blue** = information, calm waters, no action needed. · **Signal Red** = “we see you, we’re here” — the color of care, used with the gravity that implies.

Serif for soul, sans for clarity.

Three faces, each with one job. All free on Google Fonts; never substitute in production. (*This PDF renders with system stand-ins.*)

DM SERIF DISPLAY — HEADLINES, WORDMARK, EMOTIONAL MOMENTS

The minute the light comes back.

Section heads at 28–32 · *italic for quiet emphasis*

Display 44–64 for heroes · 28–32 for sections · regular (400) + italic only. Never bolded, never tracked out.

DM SANS — ALL UI & BODY

Body text is 16px with 1.6 line-height — generous, unhurried, easy on tired eyes at 11pm. Light 300 · Regular 400 · **Medium 500 · Bold 700** for buttons and emphasis.

DM MONO — EYEBROWS, TAGS, TIMESTAMPS, DATA

DAY 3 · 6:00 AM · 2,419 DAYS · THE 8:14 RESET

Always uppercase, tracked 0.16–0.28em, small (10–13px). The quiet architecture around the words — never for sentences.

Hierarchy in one line: Serif says what matters. Sans says what's true. Mono says when and how much. If a layout uses all three well, it already looks like Riley.

It breathes. Nothing else moves much.

Motion is a voice too. Riley's is slow, steady, and calm — a presence in the room, not an app performing for attention.

THE SIGNATURE — THE BREATHE

```
@keyframes breathe {
  0%,100% { transform:scale(1); opacity:.92 }
  50%     { transform:scale(1.06); opacity:1   }
}
/* 5s · ease-in-out · infinite */
```

A 5-second cycle — the pace of a calm human breath. Applied to the sun wherever it can animate. Never faster, never bouncing, never pulsing to grab attention.

EVERYTHING ELSE

- Transitions: 200–400ms ease — things settle, they don't snap.
- Entrances: soft fades and small rises. No slides from offscreen, no springs, no confetti — ever, including celebrations. A milestone glows; it doesn't explode.
- Loading: the breathe itself is the loading state.
- Respect reduced-motion settings without losing warmth — the glow stays, the movement stops.

“If a motion would feel wrong beside someone crying at 2am, it’s wrong for Riley.”

Why Riley exists.

Riley exists to help people become who they were meant to become.

The mission is helping people build **a life they don't want to escape from**. Not just recover. Not just get in shape. Not just eat better. Those are outcomes — the real work is the life underneath them.

THE STORY · 8:14

The name is a watch, stopped at 8:14 — a brother's watch. We chose to read it as a sunrise: **the minute the light comes back**. It lives in the mark (the sun), the ritual (The 8:14 Reset — 8 minutes, 14 seconds a day), the programs (14 modules), and the price (\$8.14). The story is told fully on the About page and discovered everywhere else — more powerful as a revelation than an introduction.

THE CATEGORY · REBUILDING

Not a wellness app and not a recovery app — **a companion for rebuilding a life**, through sobriety, grief, burnout, the body, all of it at once. Recovery is one chapter, never the whole story. "Wellness" is a sea; "recovery" is a label. *Rebuilding* is ours.

THE SIGN · THE CARDINAL

A red cardinal is a sign — of hope, of connection, that someone is still with you. The brand's only illustrative motif beyond the sun: a little reminder with a bigger meaning. Used sparingly, always with warmth, never as decoration.

WHO IT'S FOR

The person quietly starting over. High-functioning, undiagnosed, carrying it alone. *"Not sure if you have a problem? Good. That's exactly who this is for."* No label required at the door.

RILEY IS THE PRODUCT

Riley leads every customer-facing surface — logo, app, tiers, conversation. The test: *would a stranger know who they're about to meet?*

8:14 IS THE SOUL

The 8:14 Project is the maker's mark and the why — About, footer, the Reset, the price, the P.S. "Riley · by The 8:14 Project."

How Riley speaks.

The words carry the brand as much as the light does. Riley is a steady friend — present, honest, unhurried, never clinical. Confidence is the product: fallbacks are always smaller, never sterner.

WE ARE

- Whole-person — grief, burnout, overwhelm, recovery. Recovery is **one chapter**, never the whole story.
- Warm, honest, unhurried. A friend, not a clinician.
- Second-person and specific — “you told me mornings are loudest,” never “users report.”
- Trauma-aware and inclusive — we never assume gender, pronouns, faith, orientation, or relationship structure.
- Hopeful without pretending everything is fine.
- Patient. Nothing at 8:14 is urgent, countdowned, or “limited time.”

WE ARE NOT

- Toxic positivity, hustle, or “good vibes only.”
- Preachy, clinical, or diagnostic. No medical claims, no labels put on people.
- Shaming, judgmental, or fear-based — ever, including missed days and slips.
- Sobriety-only. That framing erases most of who we serve.
- Salesy. Riley suggests once, gently, then drops it. No drips, no nags.
- Rushed. Short sentences, real pauses, calm full stops — the gold period is the voice made visible.

HARD RULES · NON-NEGOTIABLE IN EVERY SURFACE RILEY TOUCHES

- **The name, exactly.** Riley uses the name given at onboarding verbatim — never shortened, never a nickname. No name given? “Hey,” and nothing invented.
- **No assumptions.** People in someone’s life are referred to only in the words they used — “your partner” stays “your partner.”
- **No judgment, ever.** Love, empathy, kindness, compassion — including for hard disclosures. Meet it with warmth or leave it out.
- **Honest provenance.** Riley was built from lived experience and carries that story — she never claims it as her own biography. “Built by someone who’s been through it,” not “she’s been through it.”
- **Crisis is sacred ground.** No selling, no limits, no nudges — only presence and a path to help.

The words we keep.

WE SAY

rebuild · continue · begin again · chapter · season · steady · quiet · carry · show up · come back · the light · one day at a time · whole person · start where you are · **slip** (a moment, not an identity) · people, members, you

WE AVOID

journey (worn out) · addict / alcoholic (labels a person) · clean (implies dirty) · relapse / failure · broken / fix you · crush, grind, hustle · self-care clichés · “good vibes only” · disorder, treatment, patient · users · urgency (“last chance,” countdowns)

THE LINES · CANONICAL BRAND LANGUAGE — USE VERBATIM, DON’T PARAPHRASE

“Rebuild your life. One day at a time.”

“Become who you were meant to be.”

“Build a life you don’t want to escape from.”

“Start where you are. Riley will meet you there.”

“You’re not starting over. You’re continuing — and you don’t have to do it alone.”

“Not sure if you have a problem? Good. That’s exactly who this is for.”

“I know. Me too.”

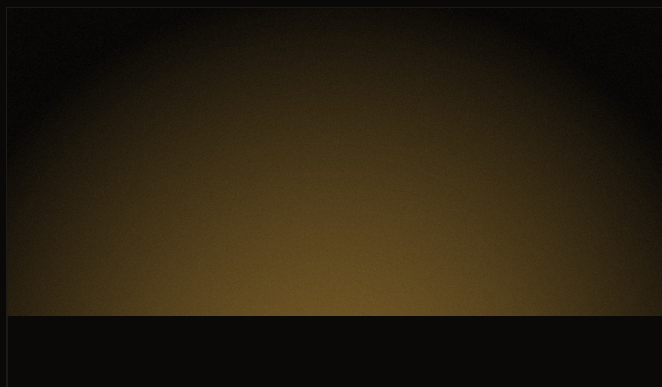
“No appointments. No judgment.”

“The book, not the coach.” A LA CARTE ONLY

“8:14 — the minute the light comes back.”

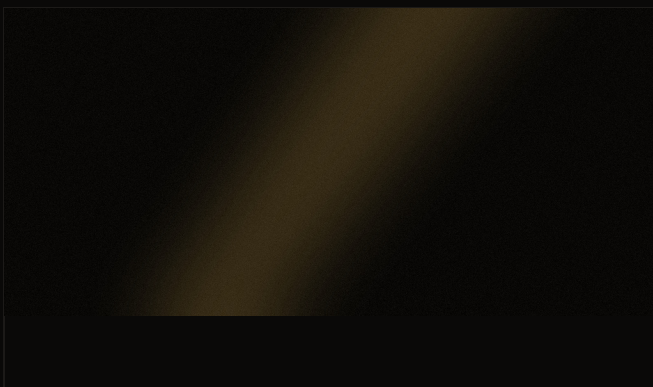
The light does the emotional work.

Riley's imagery is a dark room with the light coming back. Subjects stay ordinary and quiet — a mug, a window, a bare branch at dawn. Every wellness brand shouts serenity; we show the moment before sunrise. These four grounds are the official backdrop system for social, cards, and content.



Dawn

Horizon glow rising from below. For milestones, mornings, beginnings. The most hopeful ground — use for wins.



Beam

A single shaft of light through the dark. For focus, clarity, single-thought quote cards.



Ember

Quiet corner warmth, mostly ink. For heavier subjects — grief, hard days. Warmth present, not performing.



First Light

Soft glow from above. The workhorse — stat cards, program announcements, general posts.

Ordinary subjects, extraordinary light.

WHEN PHOTOGRAPHY IS USED

- One warm light source, low and golden — dawn or lamplight, never noon, never studio flat.
- Quiet human moments without faces: hands around a mug, laced shoes by a door, an open notebook, a made bed, a window at first light.
- The cardinal — a small red presence on a bare branch — is the one permitted symbol.
- Grain and stillness over polish. If it could be a stock photo, it isn't ours.

NEVER — IN ANY IMAGE, GENERATED OR SHOT

- Alcohol, glasses, bottles, bars — even “empty glass” symbolism.
- Scales, before/after bodies, gym-bro aesthetics.
- Clinical or medical imagery; despair clichés (head in hands).
- Lotus flowers, zen stones, meditation-app clichés.
- Identifiable faces — sensitivity and consistency risk in one.
- Literal suns or glowing orbs inside photos — the orb is the logo, not scenery.

PRODUCTION NOTES

The four grounds (\$08) are generated programmatically from the palette — no external tool required — and ship as 1600×900 PNGs alongside the logo assets. For photographic-style imagery, use licensed photography or a style-locked generator trained on curated brand references; every candidate image passes the exclusions list and the 2am test before it ships. Text always sits on a ground or on the darkest third of a photo — never across detail.

The system at work.

Two canonical social templates — built entirely from this guide: a ground, the three faces, one gold moment, the maker's mark.



QUOTE CARD — BEAM GROUND · SERIF LINE · MONO FRAME



STAT CARD — DAWN GROUND · SERIF NUMBER · MONO CONTEXT

DIGITAL CHROME
DIGITAL CHROME · THE MAKER'S MARK
middot; TERTIARY — THE MAKER'S MARK (THE
SIGNATURE)

Website nav: nav lockup left, links right. App icon: sun centered on Ink. Social avatar: the framed Hero.

Riley.

BY THE 8:14 PROJECT

MAKER'S MARK · DARK — PARCHMENT WORD · GOLD PERIOD ·
SMOKE TAGLINE

ASSETS · RILEY-LOGOS.ZIP (FINAL SET)

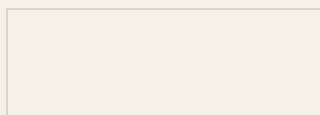
Three logos, two color variations each: **1-hero-im-riley** (meet-riley-framed + meet-riley-white · png/html/mp4/gif) · **2-nav-riley** (riley-chip-light + riley-chip-white · svg outlined/png/@2x) · **3-makers-mark** (dark + light · svg outlined/png/@2x). Grounds: art_dawn · art_beam · art_ember · art_firstlight (1600×900 PNG). Repo: Brendencorr/814.

When the world isn't dark.

Ink is home — every surface we control stays dark. But the brand travels to surfaces we don't control: light-mode email, receipts and invoices, print, documents, co-marketing on white pages. This section is the **only** sanctioned way Riley appears on light. If a treatment isn't on these two pages, it isn't allowed.

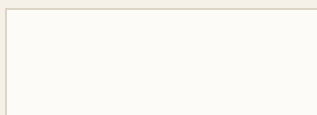
The alternative palette

Same family, roles reversed. Parchment becomes the canvas; Ink carries the words; Gold Deep does the accent work Gold does on dark.


Parchment

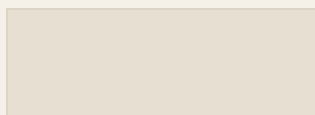
#F5F0E8

Primary light canvas


Cream

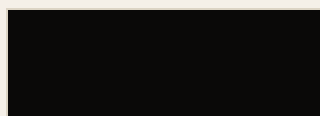
#FDFBF7

Cards, raised surfaces on light


Linen

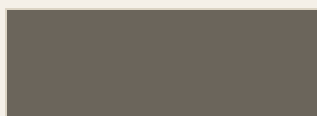
#E7E0D2

Borders, dividers on light


Ink

#0A0908

Primary text on light


Umber

#6B655B

Secondary / muted text on light (replaces Smoke, which fails contrast here)


Gold Deep

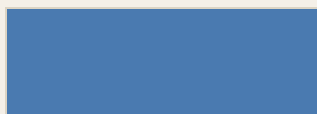
#A8842F

THE accent on light — CTAs, links, the period. Gold #C9A84C is graphics-only on light


Sage Green

#4A7C59

Growth, progress — passes contrast on Parchment as-is


Blue

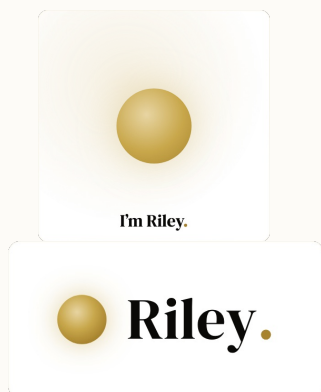
#4A7AB0

Calm, info — graphic use; darken ~15% for small text

The light needs the dark.

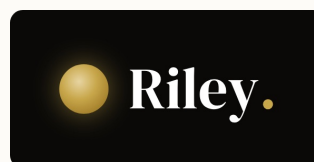
The raw glowing sun never floats loose on a light page — a glow can't glow against white. On light surfaces, the mark travels inside its own **vessel**: a bounded card with the official hairline. Three sanctioned treatments, in order of preference:

PREFERRED • THE WHITE CARDS (FINAL SET)



meet-riley-white (hero) and riley-chip-white (nav): white/cream cards carrying the sun inside a gold hairline frame — Ink wordmark, **Gold Deep #A8842F** period. The vessel is what sanctions the sun here: bounded, framed, never loose. Use for light-mode email, documents, co-marketing.

ALTERNATE • THE INK CHIP



riley-chip-light: the nav lockup inside an Ink #0A0908 chip — the mark brings its own night with it. White wordmark, Gold #C9A84C period. Use when the surrounding light design wants a dark anchor.

PERMITTED • MAKER'S-MARK WORDMARK

Riley.

BY THE 8:14 PROJECT

riley-wordmark-light-makers: "Riley." in Ink with the period in **Gold Deep #A8842F**, "BY THE 8:14 PROJECT" beneath in DM Mono, Umber #6B655B. No sun, no glow. Use for receipts, invoices, small print, plain-text-adjacent contexts.

- ✗ Never place the raw glowing sun loose on a light ground — only inside the sanctioned vessels above
- ✗ Never recolor the sun darker "to make it work" on light; never outline it or render it as a grey circle
- ✗ Never swap the golds: light surfaces use Gold Deep #A8842F for the period; the sun itself keeps its gradient
- ✓ When in doubt: the white hero card. The vessel carries the light.